How to raise an IT ticket and what information to include

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Summary

This article explains how Acme Global employees can raise an IT ticket using the self-service portal, phone, or Teams channel. It outlines the essential information to include so that the Service Desk L1 team can diagnose and resolve issues quickly. Follow the step-by-step guide to submit a ticket correctly and avoid delays.

Symptoms

- Need to report an IT issue but unsure how to start
- Unclear what details to provide when opening a ticket
- Tickets rejected or delayed due to missing information

Common causes

- Users unaware of the available submission channels (portal, phone, Teams)
- Lack of guidance on required ticket fields
- Varied processes across different teams leading to confusion

Submit a ticket via the IT self-service portal

Open a web browser and go to the IT self-service portal at https://it.acme.example. Sign in with your Acme Global email address and password; if you have MFA enabled, approve the push notification in Microsoft Authenticator or enter the SMS code. Once logged in, click the 'New Ticket' button on the dashboard to open the ticket form.

1. Select the appropriate service group (e.g., Desktop Support, Messaging & Collaboration) from the dropdown menu.
2. Choose a priority level based on the impact: P1 for critical outages, P2 for high-impact issues, P3 for moderate, P4 for low.
3. Enter a concise title that summarises the problem (e.g., 'Outlook unable to connect to Exchange').
4. In the description field, provide a detailed account of the issue, including any error messages, steps to reproduce, and the device name or asset tag.
5. Attach relevant screenshots or logs, then click 'Submit' to create the ticket.

Submit a ticket by phone or Teams

If you prefer to speak directly with an agent or need immediate assistance for a P1 issue, call the Service Desk on extension 4357 (HELP). For non-urgent queries, you can also post a message in the Teams channel "IT Help". Agents monitor the channel during business hours and will convert your message into a ticket.

1. Dial extension 4357 from any internal phone or dial the external number provided in the office directory.
2. When prompted, state your name, employee ID, and a brief summary of the problem.
3. Follow the agent's instructions to provide additional details; they will create the ticket on your behalf and give you a ticket number.
4. Alternatively, open Teams, navigate to the 'IT Help' channel, and post a message that includes your contact information and a clear description of the issue.
5. An agent will respond, ask for any missing information, and then log a ticket, sharing the ticket number with you.

Essential information to include in every ticket

Providing complete information up front reduces back-and-forth and helps the Service Desk meet its resolution targets. Think of the ticket as a mini-report that answers who, what, when, where, and how. The more precise you are, the faster the appropriate team can act.

1. Title: Summarise the issue in fewer than 60 characters; avoid vague phrases like 'Help' or 'Problem'.
2. Description: List the symptoms, any exact error messages, the time the issue first occurred, and the frequency (intermittent or constant).
3. Device details: Include the device hostname, asset tag, operating system version, and whether it is a laptop, desktop, or mobile device.

4. Steps to reproduce: Number the actions that lead to the problem so that agents can replicate it.
5. Impact: State how many users are affected and what business functions are disrupted (e.g., unable to send email, cannot access shared drive).
6. Attachments: Add screenshots, error logs, or relevant files that illustrate the problem.

Service Desk L1 agent ticket triage procedure

Once a ticket arrives, L1 agents perform an initial assessment to determine whether they can resolve it immediately or need to escalate to a specialist team. This procedure ensures tickets are routed correctly and that SLA clocks start promptly.

1. Open the ticket and verify the caller's identity using the employee ID or Azure AD login details recorded in the ticket.
2. Review the title and description; if information is missing, add a note requesting the missing details and set the ticket to 'Pending User Response'.
3. Determine the correct support group based on the symptom and selected category (e.g., network connectivity -> Network Support, Outlook issues -> Messaging & Collaboration).
4. Adjust the priority if the initial selection does not match the observed impact; document the reason for any change.
5. Assign the ticket to the appropriate group or, if within L1 scope, begin troubleshooting using known-error articles and remote tools.
6. Update the ticket with work performed, and if resolved, set the status to 'Resolved' and notify the user for confirmation.

Verification, closure and feedback

After the incident is resolved, it is important to confirm that the user can resume normal work and to capture any lessons learned. Closing the ticket properly also contributes to accurate reporting and metrics.

1. Ask the user to test the solution and confirm that the issue is fully resolved.
2. If the user agrees, change the ticket status to 'Closed' and add a closure summary outlining the root cause and the fix applied.
3. If the problem persists, reopen the ticket, reassess the diagnosis, and consider escalation to a higher-level team.
4. Encourage the user to fill out the short satisfaction survey that appears after closure to help improve service quality.
5. Document any workaround or permanent fix in the knowledge base for future reference.

When to escalate

Escalate to the relevant specialist team (Identity & Access Management, Network Support, Desktop Support, Messaging & Collaboration, Application Support, or Security Operations) when L1 agents cannot resolve the issue within the agreed SLA, when the problem requires specialised tools or permissions, or when the user reports a recurring issue. Include the ticket number, a summary of steps already taken, logs or screenshots, and any error codes. Use the transfer function in the ticketing system and notify the user of the escalation and expected response time.

Keywords: raise ticket, create IT ticket, submit incident, how to log a ticket, ticket information, service desk, IT help, self-service portal, phone support, Teams ticket